

Smart Store Innovation

How Interactive Retail Technology Empowers Modern Cannabis Retailers

Setting the Stage

In today's cannabis retail landscape, customer expectations are evolving faster than ever. Consumers want more: instant product insights, intuitive shopping journeys, and memorable in-store experiences. For fast-growing regional dispensaries and independent multi-location brands, meeting these demands isn't optional — it's the new standard for success.

Forward-thinking cannabis retailers like Lazy River Products, Klutch Cannabis, and A21 Dispensary are leading this transformation by embracing Smart Store technology — blending innovation, education, and operational efficiency to create experiences that customers remember.

The Challenge

- Consumers expect **instant access to product information** and **self-guided shopping experiences**.
- **Staff shortages and rising labor costs** strain traditional service models.
- Growing competition makes **customer experience** the decisive factor for loyalty and growth.

Modern cannabis retailers needed a future-proof strategy to **differentiate their brand**, **deliver exceptional customer journeys**, and **scale operations efficiently** without overwhelming their teams.

The Smart Store Solution

To help ambitious cannabis operators lead the next evolution of retail, The Peak Beyond delivers Smart Store solutions designed to blend technology with human connection:

- **Interactive Shopping Kiosks** that allow customers to explore products, build carts, and learn independently.
- **Digital Menus and Displays** offering real-time updates on strains, effects, inventory, and promotions.
- **Self-Service Checkout Stations** to streamline transactions and minimize wait times.

These tools empower dispensaries to create modern, intuitive retail environments — elevating both the customer experience and operational performance.

Why Smart Retail Matters Now

Across industries, interactive technology is reshaping retail:

- The global interactive kiosk market is projected to grow from **\$28.45 billion in 2021** to **\$52.74 billion by 2030** (Grand View Research).
- Interactive kiosks improve **customer engagement** by delivering real-time product information and tailored promotions (Engagis).
- They enhance **operational efficiency** by automating routine tasks like order placement and FAQs (Israk).
- They drive **data-driven decision making** through customer interaction insights (Israk).

In cannabis retail, these trends translate into:

- Empowered customers who confidently explore and purchase.
- Shorter lines and faster checkout experiences.
- Greater upsell opportunities through targeted in-store promotions.
- Staff freed to focus on high-value, relationship-building interactions.

The Outcomes

✨ Increased Customer Engagement

- Visitors engaged with an average of **12–18 products per visit**.
- In-store session times rose by **20–30%**, supporting deeper exploration and more informed purchasing.
- At A21 Dispensary, displays logged an average of **15.3 clicks per session**, with customers spending over **22 minutes** actively engaged.

✨ Higher Sales Metrics

- Average transaction sizes grew by **15–25%** post-Smart Store implementation.
- Digital promotions achieved **conversion rates up to 70%**, driving immediate sales uplift.
- At Klutch Cannabis, educational kiosks boosted upsells in high-margin categories like concentrates and edibles.

✨ Improved Operational Efficiency

- Dispensaries served **more customers with fewer staff** during peak periods.
- Staff shifted from order processing to high-touch education and customer support.
- Lazy River Products cited Smart Store kiosks as critical to managing expansion to their second location without proportional labor increases.

✨ Stronger Brand Differentiation

- Operators positioned themselves as **technology-forward, customer-first brands**.
- Smacked Village in New York combined tech enhancements with a focus on social equity, reinforcing brand trust and loyalty.

Voices from the Industry

"The displays provide an engaging, self-directed shopping experience, helping customers make informed choices while reducing wait times."

— A21 Dispensary

"Our guests are empowered to shop their way. Technology gives them the freedom to explore while our team is free to build real connections."

— Smacked Village Owner (source: Green Market Report)

Conclusion

Smart Store innovation is more than a technology upgrade — it's a strategy for future-proofing cannabis retail. By embracing interactive shopping solutions, today's most forward-thinking operators are building customer loyalty, improving margins, and positioning their brands for long-term leadership.